PREPARATION / RADIO CHECK

Before the first call

SET UP

CHECK	Flight plan filed; charts, departure route and airport diagram ready.
CHECK	Listen to ATIS and note its letter, runway, QNH and relevant information.
CHECK	Identify the appropriate controller and listen before transmitting.

A radio check is optional. Keep the frequency clear when it is busy.

RADIO CHECK / choose one

PILOT	[Station], [callsign], radio check.
ATC	[Callsign], readability five.
PILOT	Readability five, [callsign].
IF WEAK	[Callsign], readability two. Please check your microphone.

Readability is reported from 1 (unreadable) to 5 (perfectly readable).

FIRST CONTACT

FORMULA	Station + full callsign + position + information + request.
EXAMPLE	Rome Delivery, Speedbird one two three, stand two zero one, information Alpha, request IFR clearance to London Heathrow.

Write down the clearance before reading it back.

DENIS-AVIATION
DENIS-AVIATION

DEPARTURE / AT THE STAND

Clearance & start

IFR CLEARANCE

ATC	Speedbird one two three, cleared to London Heathrow via [SID], initial climb [altitude], squawk [code].
PILOT	Cleared to London Heathrow via [SID], initial climb [altitude], squawk [code], Speedbird one two three.
CLARIFY	Confirm initial altitude, Speedbird one two three.

Read back the clearance as issued, including route, initial level, squawk and any restrictions.

PUSHBACK & ENGINE START / choose one

BOTH	[Station], [callsign], stand [number], request pushback and start.
START ONLY	[Station], [callsign], stand [number], request start-up.
ATC	[Callsign], pushback and start approved, facing [direction].
READ BACK	Pushback and start approved, facing [direction], [callsign].

An approval may include a direction or condition. Do not assume taxi approval.

DENIS-AVIATION

DENIS-AVIATION

DENIS-AV

DEPARTURE / ON THE GROUND

Taxi & runway

TAXI

PILOT	[Station], [callsign], ready to taxi.
ATC	[Callsign], taxi to holding point runway [runway] via [route], hold short of runway [runway].
READ BACK	Taxi to holding point runway [runway] via [route], hold short of runway [runway], [callsign].
UNSURE	[Callsign], confirm taxi route after [taxiway].

Taxi on the cleared route. Hold short means stop before the runway holding point.

CROSS OR HOLD / choose the actual instruction

ATC	[Callsign], cross runway [runway].
PILOT	Cross runway [runway], [callsign].
ATC	[Callsign], hold short of runway [runway].
PILOT	Hold short of runway [runway], [callsign].

A taxi clearance alone is not permission to cross an intervening runway.

TOWER HANDOFF

ATC	[Callsign], contact Tower [frequency].
PILOT	Tower [frequency], [callsign].
NEW CALL	[Tower], [callsign], holding point runway [runway], ready for departure.

Change frequency when instructed.

DENIS-AVIATION
DENIS-AVIATION

DEPARTURE / AIRBORNE

Takeoff & climb

LINE UP OR TAKE OFF / read back the one issued

ATC	[Callsign], runway [runway], line up and wait.
PILOT	Runway [runway], line up and wait, [callsign].
ATC	[Callsign], runway [runway], cleared for takeoff.
PILOT	Runway [runway], cleared for takeoff, [callsign].

Line up and wait is not a takeoff clearance.

DEPARTURE CONTACT

CHECK IN	[Departure], [callsign], passing [altitude], climbing [assigned altitude].
LEVEL	[Station], [callsign], level [altitude or flight level].
ATC	[Callsign], climb flight level one five zero.
READ BACK	Climb flight level one five zero, [callsign].

On check-in while changing level, give both your current and assigned levels.

HEADING & SPEED

ATC	[Callsign], turn right heading two seven zero, speed two one zero knots.
PILOT	Right heading two seven zero, speed two one zero knots, [callsign].

Read back turn direction, heading and speed; apply only what is assigned.

DENIS-AVIATION
DENIS-AVIATION

CRUISE / ARRIVAL PREPARATION

En route & descent

FREQUENCY CHANGE

ATC	[Callsign], contact [station] [frequency].
READ BACK	[Station] [frequency], [callsign].
LEVEL	[Station], [callsign], flight level [level].
CHANGING	[Station], [callsign], passing flight level [level], descending flight level [level].

Use the full callsign on initial contact. Do not change frequency before the handoff.

ROUTING / choose one

ATC	[Callsign], proceed direct [waypoint].
PILOT	Direct [waypoint], [callsign].
REQUEST	[Callsign], request direct [waypoint].

A request is not approval. Check the cleared waypoint before changing the route.

DESCENT

REQUEST	[Station], [callsign], request descent.
ATC	[Callsign], descend flight level one one zero.
PILOT	Descend flight level one one zero, [callsign].

Do not leave an assigned level until cleared or instructed. Prepare arrival information early.

DENIS-AVIATION
DENIS-AVIATION

ARRIVAL / IN THE TERMINAL AREA

Approach & landing

VECTORS, QNH & APPROACH

ATC	[Callsign], turn left heading two seven zero, descend altitude four thousand feet, QNH one zero one three.
PILOT	Left heading two seven zero, descend altitude four thousand feet, QNH one zero one three, [callsign].
ATC	[Callsign], cleared ILS approach runway two seven left.
PILOT	Cleared ILS approach runway two seven left, [callsign].

An approach clearance does not itself authorise landing. Follow the approach clearance and restrictions.

TOWER & LANDING

PILOT	[Tower], [callsign], established ILS runway two seven left.
ATC	[Callsign], runway two seven left, cleared to land.
PILOT	Runway two seven left, cleared to land, [callsign].

Include the complete runway designator, including left, right or centre.

GO-AROUND

PILOT	[Callsign], going around.
FOLLOW	Fly the applicable missed approach or ATC instructions, as appropriate.

Advise ATC promptly and listen for further instructions.

DENIS-AVIATION
DENIS-AVIATION

ARRIVAL / BACK ON THE GROUND

Vacate & park

AFTER LANDING

ATC	[Callsign], vacate via [taxiway], contact Ground [frequency] when clear.
PILOT	Vacate via [taxiway], Ground [frequency] when clear, [callsign].
PILOT	[Ground], [callsign], runway [runway] vacated via [taxiway], request taxi to stand.

Report the runway vacated only once the entire aircraft is clear of the runway holding position.

TAXI TO STAND

ATC	[Callsign], taxi to stand [number] via [route].
PILOT	Taxi to stand [number] via [route], [callsign].
IF NEEDED	[Callsign], confirm stand [number] and taxi route.
OPTIONAL	[Callsign], on stand, thank you.

Use the airport diagram. Observe any runway crossing or hold-short instruction.

DENIS-AVIATION
DENIS-AVIATION
DENIS-AVIA

QUICK REFERENCE / CHOOSE THE PHRASE

When you need help

ASK, CONFIRM OR DECLINE

REPEAT	Say again, [callsign].
PART	Say again the taxi route, [callsign].
SLOWER	Speak slower, [callsign].
CONFIRM	Confirm assigned altitude, [callsign].
UNABLE	Unable [instruction], request [alternative], [callsign].
WAIT	Stand by, [callsign].

If you are unsure, ask before acting. Acknowledge instructions addressed to your callsign.

READBACK QUICK LIST

ROUTE	Route / SID / approach, assigned level and any restrictions.
GROUND	Taxi route, runway, hold-short, crossing, line-up, takeoff and landing clearances.
SETTINGS	Heading and direction, speed, QNH, squawk and frequency.

Read back what was actually issued; local procedures and controller instructions can differ.

REFERENCES

VATSIM	vatsim.net/docs/pilots/pilot-basics/
LOCAL	docs.vatsim.uk/Pilots/
RADIO	faa.gov/air_traffic/publications/aim_html/chap4_section_3.html

Use current charts, local procedures and the instructions you receive.

DENIS-AVIATION
DENIS-AVIATION

ADVISORY / COORDINATE WITH TRAFFIC

No controller online

CHECK COVERAGE FIRST

CHECK	An approach or centre controller may cover lower positions. Check the available ATC and local information.
FREQUENCY	Without applicable ATC, monitor the designated advisory frequency. If none is published, use 122.800.
PRINCIPLE	Advisory calls communicate intentions; they are not clearances.

Monitor traffic, follow local procedures and keep calls concise.

ADVISORY CALLS / choose the phase

TAXI	[Airport] traffic, [callsign], taxiing from stand [number] to runway [runway] via [route], [airport].
DEPART	[Airport] traffic, [callsign], departing runway [runway], [departure direction], [airport].
ARRIVAL	[Airport] traffic, [callsign], [distance] miles [direction], inbound for runway [runway], [airport].
VACATED	[Airport] traffic, [callsign], runway [runway] vacated via [taxiway], [airport].

These are position reports. They do not authorise crossing, takeoff or landing.

PREPARE FOR ATC

CHANGE	When entering controlled coverage, contact the appropriate unit as required.
CHECK IN	[Station], [callsign], [position], [level] and [intentions].

Review current local frequency and coverage information before departure.

DENIS-AVIATION
DENIS-AVIATION